

The full Google Business Profile **optimization checklist** for contractors.

Every field, every step, every backup move. Same checklist Tekton Growth runs on every new client. Print it. Tape it to the wall. Tick it as you go.

01 NAP consistency (do this first)

FOUNDATION RULE

Your **Name, Address, and Phone Number** must be identical across every online platform — your website, GBP, Yelp, BBB, Facebook, every directory. Inconsistencies tell Google you might be three different businesses.

02 Profile setup — every field

- ☐ **Business Name.** Use the exact legal/registered name. No keyword stuffing — Google clips it and flags trust.
- ☐ **Profile Picture.** 3D version of your logo if possible. Otherwise a clean square logo on solid background.
- ☐ **Cover Photo.** Imagery that matches your service focus. For hardscape, a finished patio. For HVAC, a crew on site. Real, not stock.
- ☐ **Primary Category.** Pick the most specific match for your money service (e.g., "Paver Contractor" over "Contractor").
- ☐ **Secondary Categories.** Add 3-5 more covering your real service mix. After picking each category, drill into the Service Options Google offers under it.
- ☐ **Services.** Manually add anything not auto-captured by category selection. The more granular, the better.
- ☐ **Business Address.** Use a real address if you can. Businesses rank in roughly a 15-mile radius from their listed address. If you're a service-area-only profile (no displayed address), your ranking ceiling drops hard. **PRO** A virtual office in a strategic location can dramatically expand your service radius.
- ☐ **Shortname.** Match your business name. Used in your share-friendly Google review URL.
- ☐ **Phone.** Local business line — same number that's on your website.
- ☐ **Website.** Link to your live site (or a placeholder URL if not live yet — fill it in later).
- ☐ **Business Description.** Cover your services, your unique selling points, and your customer commitment. Use service-area keywords naturally. No keyword stuffing.
- ☐ **Operating Hours.** Real hours. **Don't pick 24/7** — Google flags it as suspicious for service trades.
- ☐ **Photos.** Upload work photos, equipment, crew, vehicles, the shop. Aim for 30+ at launch and 3-5 new per month.
- ☐ **Q&A.** Seed roughly 10 FAQs that map to your primary services and service areas. Answer each one yourself.
- ☐ **Service Areas.** Add every city and zip code you actually service.
- ☐ **Booking Button.** Point to your website's contact page or a calendar booking link.
- ☐ **Products.** Re-add your services here with a picture and short description for each.

- ☐ **Social Links.** Connect every social profile you actually maintain.
- ☐ **"More" Section.** Fill in the From-the-Business field and all relevant Service Options.
- ☐ **Messaging.** Turn it on. Then commit to monitoring it.

Recurring maintenance + the **95% video verification** playbook.

Optimization is one-time. Maintenance is forever. And video verification is where most contractors get stuck — here's the process Tekton Growth uses with a 95% pass rate.

03 Recurring maintenance

- ☐ **Review acquisition.** Ask every customer. Reviews are the currency Google uses to measure work activity and local authority. Reviews boost rankings **and** Google Ads quality scores.
- ☐ **GBP messages.** Monitor them. Respond fast. Slow responses kill conversion and Google penalizes neglect.
- ☐ **Review responses.** Respond to all of them, especially the bad ones. Use them to showcase professionalism to the next 10 readers, not the one customer.
- ☐ **Photos + posts.** Frequent uploads. Aim for one post and 3-5 photos per week.
- ☐ **Insights review.** Check it monthly. See how your effort is moving the needle (search visibility, calls, direction requests, photo views).

04 Video verification — 95% pass rate prep

When you set up a new GBP or change your address, Google triggers verification. Get prepped before you submit so you don't get stuck in re-shoot loops.

- ☐ **Office door canvas/sign.** CRUCIAL. A printed sign that has your business name on it, hangable on a door.
- ☐ **Business cards.** Printed, with NAP that matches the GBP exactly.
- ☐ **Vehicle branding.** Wrap, lettering, or magnet — anything that ties the truck to the business.
- ☐ **Branded shirt + hat.** Optional but lifts pass rate. Wear them in the video.

WHERE TO PRINT

Design on Canva or Fiverr. Print on VistaPrint. Don't skip the canvas/sign — that's the single most common reason contractor verifications fail.

05 Backup: business identity verification

If video verification fails, Google escalates to identity verification. **Get these ready now** so you can move in one day instead of waiting for a re-trigger.

PHOTOS TO GATHER

- ☐ Vehicles or equipment
- ☐ Outside of the location
- ☐ Street sign at the address

DOCUMENTS (ANY ONE)

- ☐ Business registration (with address)
- ☐ Insurance certificate (with address)
- ☐ Licensing (with address)
- ☐ Utility bill (with address)

The video verification shoot script.

Run through this exactly. Attention to detail here saves you a 7-day rejection cycle. Re-read Google's instructions in the verification flow before you hit record.

06 The shoot — start outside

Introduce yourself. "Hi, I'm [your name], owner of [business]." Wear your branded shirt and hat.

Show your business card on camera. Hold it close enough to read.

Show vehicle branding. Wrap, lettering, magnet — whatever you have. Show it clearly.

Show equipment in the vehicle or shop.

Show the outside of the building. Pan across the building, the street, surrounding buildings, and the street sign if visible.

07 Go inside — public and private offices

Open "Public Office." This is where the canvas/sign goes. Open the door, briefly show the room, and say: *"This is where customers conduct business."* An office space with a desk, business cards, laptop, etc. is ideal.

Open "Private Office." Open a second door, briefly show inside, and say: *"This is where customers cannot enter."* Even a closet works — just somewhere customers don't access without permission.

IF ASKED	ANSWER
Do customers visit your location?	<i>Yes, customers can and do visit.</i>
Are you a service-area business?	<i>No, we have a physical location.</i>
Is this a virtual office?	<i>No, this is not a virtual office location.</i>

08 If you get rejected

- ☐ **First rejection.** Submit a ticket via GBP Support. Request a **Live Video Call** with a Google rep — same process, but live and easier to pass.
- ☐ **Second rejection.** Submit another ticket with your business identity documentation (page 2). Also request the Appeal Form.
- ☐ **Profile suspended?** Submit the Reinstatement Form. Use the documentation you gathered. If rejected, request the Appeal Form and follow up in the same support thread.

STUCK OR WANT THIS DONE FOR YOU?

Tekton Growth runs this full process for clients across the country. Email nick@tektongrowth.com if you want help, or run the GBP Health Check at bluecollartechy.com/gbp-check to see where your profile stands today.